6.2.3 Ruva, McEvoy and Bryant (2007) — Pre-trial Publicity and Source Memory Errors

What this workbook covers 本册讲什么

The judge says "judge only the courtroom evidence" — but the news you read last week is already **in your memory**. This booklet walks through the two-phase experiment that showed negative pre-trial publicity **biases verdicts** (73% vs 41% guilty), how jurors **misremember news as evidence**, and why deliberating together helps.

How to use this booklet 怎么用

1. **Fill it in as you go** — check the answer key (p. 20) after each page.
2. **Pages 5–10 (procedure & results) and 15 (numbers) matter most.** Do them from memory, under time.

Content map 内容地图

Page	Topic	What you must be able to do afterwards
p.2	Pre-trial publicity 问题	Explain why instructions to ignore media fail
p.3	Aim and the two juror types	Define collaborating vs nominal jurors
p.4–5	Sample and three conditions	558 · 276/140/142 · 25 groups each
p.6	Phase one 种下新闻	Cover story · 9 matched articles · planted facts
p.7	Phase two 庭审	30-min video · verdict / 1–7 rating / 30–45 years
p.8	Deliberation and the test	30-min unanimous vs 15-min recall; source monitoring test
p.9–10	Results 结果	73/41/65/37 · source errors · credibility 40.83 vs 49.57
p.11	Conclusions 结论	Bias · leniency shift · juries catch errors
p.12–13	Evaluation 评价	Strengths and limitations, each with a consequence
p.14	Application 应用	Change of venue, bench trial
p.15	Every number 数字收口	Cover the right column and test yourself
p.16	Side by side 对照	vs Bradbury and Williams (2013)
p.17	Exam skills 答题技巧	Command words, sentence frames
p.18–19	Practice A & Final check	Short answers and a memory sweep
p.20	Answer key 答案速查	Mark honestly, then re-write wrong answers in full

Revision tracker 复习打卡

☐ p.2–3 problem & aim ☐ p.4–8 procedure ☐ p.9–11 results & conclusions ☐ p.12–14 evaluation & application ☐ p.15 numbers ☐ p.16–19 exam

The whole study in one sentence 一句话总结

Of **558 students**, those who read **negative pre-trial publicity** about a real murder trial voted guilty far more often (**73%** vs 41% collaborative; **65%** vs 37% nominal), made more **source monitoring errors** — mistaking article-only facts for trial evidence, **confidently** — and rated the defendant as **less credible** (40.83 vs 49.57), while group **deliberation** shifted verdicts toward **leniency** and helped catch memory errors.

Pre-trial Publicity — The Problem

The right at stake 权利问题

Every defendant has the right to a **fair trial** and to be judged by an **impartial jury** and/or judge. But media coverage **before** the trial can be a source of bias.

Key term 关键术语

pre-trial publicity（审前报道）
News coverage about a case published **before** the trial — which may include information **never presented in court**.

What the justice system tried — and the verdict on each 应对措施

Strategy	Shown to work?
Voir dire（陪审员资格审查）	_____ (ineffective)
Judge's instruction to ignore media	_____ (ineffective)
Change of venue（更换审判地点）	Not tested experimentally; _____ done; no right to request (rarely)
Bench trial（法官审，无陪审团）	Not tested experimentally; largely _____ (prohibitive)

Extra context: some countries have **abolished juries** altogether (Singapore, South Africa, India); others use juries only for a select number of offences.

为什么口头指令没用（先想再翻答案）
因为新闻内容已经**存进记忆**。「不要想」不能删除记忆 —— 只能靠**来源监测**（想起来时分辨「这是哪里来的」），而来源监测恰恰会出错。这正是本研究的核心机制。

The Aim and the Two Juror Types + The Sample 样本

Aim 研究目的

Test whether (1) exposure to **negative pre-trial publicity** biases jurors toward **guilty** verdicts, and (2) whether **deliberating in a group** versus **thinking alone** changes the judgments — including source monitoring errors.

Two key terms 两个关键术语

Term	Meaning
Collaborating jurors 协作陪审员	Deliberate **together** for 30 minutes and give one **unanimous** group verdict (guilty / not guilty / hung)
Nominal jurors 名义陪审员	Judge **alone**; individual verdicts are pooled — **no discussion**

为什么这个对比重要

如果讨论组更准 → 「陪审团制度」本身有价值（成员互相**纠错**）；如果讨论组更糟 → 讨论可能**传染**偏见。实验结果支持前者，但有个前提 —— 详见 p.11。

Warm-up 热身

1. Jurors who deliberate together and must reach one verdict are called _____ jurors.

2. Jurors who judge individually with no discussion are called _____ jurors.

3. The test that checks whether people can correctly attribute where information came from is the _____ _____ test.

Fill in the numbers 填数字

Feature	Answer
Total participants	_____ university students （558）
Age range (and mean)	_____–_____ years (mean _____) （18–52; 20.6）
Male / female	_____ male, _____ female （128 / 430）
Majority ethnicity	white (n = _____) （354）
Prior jury experience	_____ participants had served as jurors （6）
Payment	course _____ （credit）

样本评价先埋个伏笔

430 女 vs 128 男 —— 真实陪审员群体没有这么悬殊；学生平均 20.6 岁 —— 也不是典型陪审员年龄。评价时可用「sample not representative of real jurors」。

Three Conditions 三个条件组 + Phase One — Planting the News 第一阶段

6.2.3 RUVA, MCEVOY & BRYANT (2007)

Complete the table 补全分组表

Condition	n	What they read
Collaborating condition	_____	negative pre-trial publicity; at phase 2 split into collaborative (n = _____) or nominal (n = _____)
Nominal — exposed	_____	negative pre-trial publicity
Nominal — non-exposed（控制组）	_____	_____ crime articles

There were **25 groups** in each condition. Answers: 276 · 138 · 138 · 140 · 142 · unrelated.

> **分组逻辑一图流**
> **读没读负面新闻**（exposed vs non-exposed）是第一层对比 → 测「新闻有没有影响」。
> **讨论不讨论**（collaborative vs nominal）是第二层对比 → 测「讨论能不能纠错」。

Quick check 快问快答

1. The control condition read articles about a woman _____ child support funds.

2. Groups per condition: _____.

3. The collaborating condition contained _____ participants in total.

The cover story 掩护故事

Sessions of **16 or fewer**. Participants were told the study examined *"the stability of* _____ *reactions to different sources of information"* — a cover story to stop them guessing the real aim (jury decision-making).

The articles 文章包

Exposed groups	Non-exposed
_____ edited news articles about the **NJ v Bias** murder case (from the *Morning Call*), including facts _____ presented at trial	Nine articles about an **unrelated** crime, matched for _____ (about ten pages total)

Facts planted only in the articles 只在新闻里出现

1. Daniel Bias had a _____ （bad temper）
2. Lise's body was found in the _____ of the bedroom （doorway）
3. Lise did not know how to use _____ and disliked them （guns）
4. Daniel wanted Lise to _____ （quit her job and start a family）

After reading: **15 minutes** to recall as much as possible and rate their _____ response.

> **设计精髓**
> 「坏脾气」这类信息**庭审中不存在**。谁在测验里说「这是法庭上听到的」，谁就把新闻**误存成了证据** —— 错误被精确抓到。

Phase Two — The Trial 第二阶段 + Deliberate or Recall 讨论还是回忆 6.2.3 RUVA, MCEVOY & BRYANT (2007)

The video 庭审录像

_____–_____ days later, participants watched a **30-minute video** of the real trial *NJ v Bias*: a man accused of _____ his wife, pleading not guilty (claiming _____ shooting). His guilt was **not clear**.

Facts presented only in the trial 只在庭审中出现

1. Detective John Flynn failed to do any _____ testing on the weapon
2. Daniel had his hand on his wife's hand when the weapon _____ _____
3. Lise was standing by the _____ when the weapon went off
4. That day they had argued about a piece of _____

The three measures 三项测量

Measure	Scale
Verdict	guilty / _____
Rating of guilt	_____–_____ (1 = certain not guilty, 7 = certain guilty)
Sentence	_____–_____ years (New Jersey guidelines)

What each group did next

Collaborating jurors	Nominal jurors
_____ minutes to deliberate → one _____ verdict; no decision = _____ jury (mistrial)	Taken to a different room; _____ min recalling trial facts, _____ min indicating which facts most influenced their verdict; same verdict form, no hung option

Then, for everyone 最后所有人都做

- **Source monitoring test**: attribute each fact to the _____, the _____, or _____ — plus rate **confidence** for each answer
- A final _____ verdict, guilt rating and sentence
- Rate the defendant's _____ (e.g. “How honest did the defendant appear to be?”)
- A _____ questionnaire (did you believe the cover story?)

key term: source monitoring test（来源监测测验）
A test/questionnaire designed to see whether a person can accurately **attribute the original source** of information.

Results 1 — The Verdicts 判罪结果 + Results 2 — Source Errors and Credibility

Pre-deliberation guilty verdicts 判罪率

Group	Not guilty	Guilty
Collaborative — exposed to negative publicity	_____%	_____%
Collaborative — not exposed	59%	41%
Nominal — exposed	35%	_____%
Nominal — not exposed	63%	37%

As predicted 预测成立

Exposed groups were **significantly more likely to give a guilty verdict** (a _____-point jump for collaborative groups), gave **higher guilt ratings**, and **longer sentences**. These findings held **after** deliberation and after the source monitoring test.

Compute it 算一算

1. Collaborative groups: 73% − 41% = _____ percentage points.

2. Nominal groups: 65% − 37% = _____ percentage points.

3. In one sentence: exposure to negative pre-trial publicity _____ guilty verdicts in both group types.

Source monitoring errors 来源监测错误

- Exposed jurors made _____ source monitoring errors — they misattributed article-only facts to _____ (the trial / both), **confidently**.
- _____ jurors were more accurate than _____ jurors — group discussion helps catch memory errors.

Credibility and suspicion 可信度与怀疑

Measure	Exposed	Non-exposed
Defendant credibility (mean)	_____	_____
Believed the cover story	83%	85%
Suspected the real aim	_____%	18%

The mediation chain 中介链（考试金句）

Negative pre-trial publicity → _____ _____ errors → higher _____ ratings → defendant seen as less _____.

(The effect of publicity on guilt was MEDIATED by source monitoring errors.)

Bonus finding: verdicts shifted toward **leniency** after deliberation — possibly because discussion heightened the **"reasonable doubt"** standard, or because convicting feels more serious than acquitting.

Four conclusions, one line each

1. Negative pre-trial publicity can **bias a jury** toward guilt — in verdicts, guilt ratings and _____ (sentence length) — and toward seeing the defendant as less _____ (credible).
2. Deliberation produced a shift toward _____ (leniency).
3. Collaborating jurors were more _____ in source monitoring — a **benefit of juries**: members catch each other's _____ errors.
4. But exposed jurors _____ media information as trial evidence — media coverage may **alter the memory of a trial**, and no amount of discussion fixes a corrupted memory.

三个结论一句话版（中文）
① 负面审前报道**推高判罪**。② **集体讨论**能纠错、也更宽容。③ 一旦新闻被误存为证据，讨论也救不回来 —— 错的是记忆本身。

Sentence building 造句

Write the conclusion sentence you would use in an exam: *"Ruva et al. concluded that…"*

Strength 1 — A real trial 真实庭审

Mock jury research often uses a **fictional** trial summarised in a document. Ruva's participants watched **real court proceedings** of a real murder case → greater **ecological validity** than much research in this area.

Consequence: _____

Strength 2 — Standardised procedures 标准化

Articles _____ for length (nine each, ~ten pages), the same 30-minute video for all, fixed timings, random assignment → the experiment is _____ and the comparison fair.

Strength 3 — Deception handled carefully 欺骗的处理

The cover story was **necessary**. _____% (exposed) and _____% (non-exposed) believed it; _____% of exposed jurors suspected the real aim vs _____% non-exposed — but analysis showed suspicious participants did _____ differently, so suspicion did not distort the results.

评价句式（背结构）
Point → **Because/Example** → **Consequence**。每个优点都带后果，才有分数。

Limitation 1 — Only 30 minutes 讨论时间太短

Real jurors may deliberate _____ as reasonably needed. The 30-minute limit means the verdicts may not reflect verdicts given _____ time.

Limitation 2 — Not a real jury experience 陪审体验缺失

No _____ (summons), no juror _____, not sworn in, no judge's instructions, not a real courtroom, not a real defendant's fate. Knowing the verdict would truly convict might have made participants more _____.

Limitation 3 — Groups of four to six, not twelve 人数不对

Real juries have _____ members. Smaller groups give dissenting views _____ support — biased opinions can go _____.

Limitation 4 — The study underestimates real life 低估现实

Participants were told to dismiss specific articles read only _____ before. Real jurors absorb media over _____ or months and would discriminate _____ between coverage and trial evidence → real jurors could make _____ source errors and be _____ biased.

> **高分句（中文）**
> 实验室里效果已经这么强；真实世界媒体浸泡更久更深 —— 实验结果是**下限**，不是上限。

The logic 逻辑链

Jury decisions are biased by negative pre-trial publicity → instructing jurors to ignore media _____ (voire dire too) → so measures must go **beyond instructions**, especially for _____ cases.

Two concrete measures 两项对策

1. _____ the trial — move it to a location with less publicity about the defendant.
2. Use a _____ trial — the judge decides alone, no jury.

Both reduce the chance of an unfair trial.

Link it back 呼应前文

Why do these two work when instructions don't? Because they **physically separate** the decision-makers from the biased information, rather than asking memory to un-learn.

> **Key term**
> **bench trial**: trial by judge only — no jury.
> **voir dire**: questioning of prospective jurors to screen out bias (ineffective here).

Cover the right column, test yourself 遮住右栏自测

Question	Answer
Total participants (mean age)	**558** (20.6)
Male / female	**128 / 430**
White participants	**354**
Participants in the three conditions	**276 / 140 / 142**
Collaborative split at phase 2	**138 + 138**
Groups per condition	**25**
Articles per set (length)	**nine** (~ten pages)
Gap between phases	**4–7 days**
Trial video length	**30 minutes**
Guilty % — collaborative exposed / non-exposed	**73% / 41%**
Guilty % — nominal exposed / non-exposed	**65% / 37%**
Deliberation / recall times	**30 min / 15 min + 10 min**
Guilt rating scale / sentence range	**1–7 / 30–45 years**
Credibility means	**40.83 vs 49.57**
Believed cover story / suspected aim	**83% & 85% / 35% vs 18%**

数字卡片

558 · 276/140/142 · 25 groups · 9 articles · 4–7 days · 30 min video · 73/41 · 65/37 · 30 min deliberation · 40.83 vs 49.57 · 83/85 · 35/18.

Complete the comparison 对照表（答案见 p.20）

Issue	Ruva et al. (2007)	Bradbury and Williams (2013)
Data type	Lab experiment with a _____ trial video	_____ data from real trial records
Sample	_____ students	Records of real hung-jury trials in _____ states
Focus	Pre-trial _____ and source memory	Racial make-up of the _____
Analysis	Verdict percentages, ratings, source monitoring	_____ _____ (probability of conviction)
Ecological validity	Moderate — real trial _____, but artificial setting	_____ — real verdicts, real courtrooms
Reliability	_____ — standardised, replicable	Low — real cases cannot be replicated
Shared theme	Both show jury decisions can be _____ by information outside the courtroom evidence	

怎么背这张表

一句话反差：**Ruva 操控信息（实验可重复），B&W 读现实（不可重复但更真实）**。共同点：陪审团决策会被「法庭之外」的信息带偏。

Command words 指令词

Command word	What it demands
Describe	Facts only — two phases, measures, groups. No judgement.
Explain	The **because/why** — e.g. why the cover story was necessary.
Evaluate / assess	Strength + limitation, each with a consequence, then a verdict.

Sentence frames 万能句架

- Procedure: *“In phase one, participants read either nine articles of negative pre-trial publicity or nine unrelated crime articles, matched for length…”*
- Result with numbers: *“Exposed collaborative jurors voted guilty 73% of the time compared with 41% of non-exposed collaborative jurors.”*
- Mediation sentence: *“The effect of pre-trial publicity on guilt ratings was mediated by source monitoring errors.”*
- Evaluation: *“One strength is… which means… However, this may underestimate the effect because…”*

四个必写细节

① **两个阶段**（先读文章后看庭审）② **73% vs 41%**（最能说明问题的数字）③ **mediated by source monitoring errors**（机制句）④ **change of venue / bench trial**（应用）。

Practice A — Short Answers

Q1. Outline the procedure of Ruva, McEvoy and Bryant (2007). (4)

Q2. State the guilty-verdict percentages for exposed and non-exposed collaborative groups, and explain what they show. (4)

*Q3. Explain what is meant by a **source monitoring error** in this study, and why exposed jurors made more of them. (4)*

Q4. Describe one strength and one limitation of using a real trial video in this experiment. (4)

Final Check — Five Minutes, No Notes

Ten answers from memory 十题默检

1. Total sample (and mean age): _____
2. The three condition sizes: _____
3. What the non-exposed group read: _____
4. The cover story was about… _____
5. Gap between phases: _____
6. Length of the trial video: _____
7. Guilty % for collaborative exposed / non-exposed: _____
8. The test that caught memory mistakes: _____
9. The credibility means (exposed vs non-exposed): _____
0. Two applications: _____

Brain dump 空白默写

Close the booklet. Write everything you remember about Ruva, McEvoy and Bryant (2007) — aim → sample → procedure → one result → one evaluation point.

Answer Key 答案速查

Page 2

Table: ineffective · ineffective · rarely · prohibitive.

Page 3

1. collaborating 2. nominal 3. source monitoring

Page 4

558 · 18–52 (20.6) · 128 / 430 · 354 · 6 · credit

Page 5

276; 138; 138; 140; 142; unrelated · embezzling · 25

Page 6

emotional · nine; never · length · temper · doorway · guns · quit her job and start a family · emotional

Page 7

4–7 · murdering · accidental · fingerprint · went off · mirror · jewellery · not guilty · 1–7 · 30–45

Page 8

30; unanimous; hung · 15; 10 · articles / trial / both · individual · credibility · debrief

Page 9

27 / 73 · 65 · 32 · 28 · increased

Page 10

more; the trial or both · Collaborating; nominal · 40.83; 49.57 · 35 · source monitoring; guilt; credible

Pages 12–14

p.12: applies to real courtrooms / matched; replicable · 83; 85; 35; 18; not respond. p.13: as long; sufficient · summons; selection; lenient · 12; less; unchallenged · days; weeks; worse; more; more. p.14: fails; high-profile · Move; bench.

Page 16

real; secondary · 558; four · publicity; jury · logistic regression · video; high · high · biased

Page 18 — Practice A (model points)

Q1 Two phases: read 9 PTP or 9 unrelated articles (+15 min recall), then 4–7 days later watch the 30-min real trial video; verdict + 1–7 guilt rating + 30–45-year sentence; collaborative deliberated 30 min for a unanimous verdict, nominal recalled individually; source monitoring test last.
Q2 73% vs 41% — a 32-point jump; shows negative pre-trial publicity significantly increased guilty verdicts.
Q3 Attributing article-only facts (e.g. "bad temper") to the trial; exposed jurors had read them days earlier and misfiled them as trial evidence.
Q4 Strength: real proceedings → ecological validity. Limitation: participants lacked real jury processes (summons, selection, real consequences) so verdicts may be less considered.

答错怎么办

把答错的题**整句重写一遍**（不是只补答案），隔天再默一次。错两次以上的点，誊到 p.19 brain dump 区。